Supplementary Content 4: MOOSE Checklist for Meta-analyses of Observational Studies

Item	Recommendation	Reported on Page No
Reporting of background should include		
1	Problem definition	3
2	Hypothesis statement	-
3	Description of study outcome(s)	3
4	Type of exposure or intervention used	4-5
5	Type of study designs used	4, Table 1
6	Study population	4-5
Reporting of search strategy should include		
7	Qualifications of searchers (eg, librarians and investigators)	1, Title page
8	Search strategy, including time period included in the synthesis and key words	4, Supplementary Content 2
9	Effort to include all available studies, including contact with authors	4
10	Databases and registries searched	4, Supplementary Content 2
11	Search software used, name and version, including special features used (eg, explosion)	4, Supplementary Content 2
12	Use of hand searching (eg, reference lists of obtained articles)	4
13	List of citations located and those excluded, including justification	8, Fig 1
14	Method of addressing articles published in languages other than English	5
15	Method of handling abstracts and unpublished studies	5
16	Description of any contact with authors	4
Reporting of methods should include		
17	Description of relevance or appropriateness of studies assembled for assessing the hypothesis to be tested	4-6
18	Rationale for the selection and coding of data (eg, sound clinical principles or convenience)	4-6
19	Documentation of how data were classified and coded (eg, multiple raters, blinding and interrater reliability)	6-7
20	Assessment of confounding (eg, comparability of cases and controls in studies where appropriate)	9, Fig 2 A-B
21	Assessment of study quality, including blinding of quality assessors, stratification or regression on possible predictors of study results	6
22	Assessment of heterogeneity	7
23	Description of statistical methods (eg, complete description of fixed or random effects models, justification of whether the chosen models account for predictors of study results, dose-response models, or cumulative meta-analysis) in sufficient detail to be replicated	6-7
24	Provision of appropriate tables and graphics	Table 1-2 Fig 1-5
Reporting of results should include		
25	Graphic summarizing individual study estimates and overall estimate	Fig 1-5
26	Table giving descriptive information for each study included	Table 1-2
27	Results of sensitivity testing (eg, subgroup analysis)	Fig 2-4

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28	Indication of statistical uncertainty of findings	7
Reporting of discussion should include		
29	Quantitative assessment of bias (eg, publication bias)	8, Table 1
30	Justification for exclusion (eg, exclusion of non-English language citations)	5, Fig 1
31	Assessment of quality of included studies	8, Table 1
Reporting of conclusions should include		
32	Consideration of alternative explanations for observed results	11-14
33	Generalization of the conclusions (ie, appropriate for the data presented and within the domain of the literature review)	11-12
34	Guidelines for future research	15
35	Disclosure of funding source	16

From: Stroup DF, Berlin JA, Morton SC, et al, for the Meta-analysis Of Observational Studies in Epidemiology (MOOSE) Group. Meta-analysis of Observational Studies in Epidemiology. A Proposal for Reporting. *JAMA*. 2000;283(15):2008-2012. doi: 10.1001/jama.283.15.2008.